
Colorado River Basin Regional Water Quality Control Board

March 22, 2021

Tony Culver
Assistant General Manager-Operations
Hi-Desert Water District
55439 29 Palms Highway
Yucca Valley, CA 92284
tonyc@hdwd.com

SUBJECT: RESPONSE TO REQUEST FOR CHANGE TO THREAT TO WATER QUALITY RATING, ORDER R7-2015-0043

FACILITY: HI-DESERT WATER DISTRICT, YUCCA VALLEY WASTEWATER RECLAMATION PLANT, YUCCA VALLEY, SAN BERNARDINO COUNTY

Dear Mr. Culver,

The Colorado River Basin Regional Water Board (Regional Water Board) received your letter requesting to change the threat to water quality rating from 1B to 3B for Hi-Desert Water District, Yucca Valley Wastewater Reclamation Plant (WRP) on February 1, 2021.

Hi-Desert Water District (HDWD) is authorized to discharge wastewater under Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) contained in Order R7-2015-0043, adopted by the Regional Water Board on September 17, 2015. Order R7-2015-0043 contains WDRs and a Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) for waste discharges by HDWD, from the WRP. Under the terms of the WDRs, HDWD can discharge up to 1 million gallons per day of treated wastewater.

The following are the category definitions set by California Code of Regulations, Title 23, Division 3, Chapter 9, Article 1, § 2200(a)(1):

- The threat to water quality (TTWQ) **Category 1** includes those discharges of waste that could cause the long-term loss of a designated beneficial use of the receiving water. Examples of long-term loss of a beneficial use include the loss of drinking water supply, the closure of an area used for water contact recreation, or the posting of an area used for spawning or growth of aquatic resources, including shellfish and migratory fish.
- The TTWQ **Category 2** includes those discharges of waste that could impair the designated beneficial uses of the receiving water, cause short-term violations of

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water objectives, cause secondary drinking water standards to be violated or cause a nuisance.

- The TTWQ **Category 3** includes those dischargers of waste that could degrade water quality without violating water quality objectives or could cause a minor impairment of designated beneficial uses as compared to Category 1 and Category 2.
- The Complexity **Category A** is any discharge of toxic wastes; any small volume discharge containing toxic waste; any facility having numerous discharge points and groundwater monitoring; or any Class I waste management unit.
- The Complexity **Category B** is any discharger not included in Category A that has physical, chemical, or biological treatment systems (except for septic systems with subsurface disposal), or any Class 2 or Class 3 waste management units. The Complexity Category B is deemed the most appropriate rating by both the Regional Water Board and HDWD.

Regional Water Board staff agree that the discharge from the WRF does not meet the definition of TTWQ – Category 1, however, although the level of treatment and the quality of the discharge produced is high, there is still a potential to cause short-term violations of water objectives and cause secondary drinking water standards to be violated, which is represented by Category 2. Thus, the threat to water quality for the Facility has been changed from 1B to 2B.

Regional Water Board staff have reviewed your request and deemed a rating of 2B to be more appropriate based on the threat to water quality and complexity definitions set by California Code of Regulations, Title 23, Division 3, Chapter 9, Article 1, § 2200(a)(1).

If you have any questions concerning this matter, please contact the Case Manager Adriana Godinez at (760) 346-6585 (Adriana.Godinez@waterboards.ca.gov) or the Land Disposal Unit Chief, Jose Cortez at (760) 776-8963 (Jose.Cortez@waterboards.ca.gov).

Sincerely,



Paula Rasmussen
Executive Officer
Colorado River Basin
Regional Water Quality Control Board

AG/jc

cc: Doug Culbert, Chief Plant Operator dougc@hdwd.com
Samantha Mena, Construction Project Coordinator samantham@hdwd.com
Jonathan Abadesco, Chief Financial Officer jonathana@hdwd.com
Josh Dugas, Director of Environmental Health, County of San Bernardino,
josh.dugas@dph.sbcounty.gov
Curtis Yakimow, Town Manager, townmanager@yucca-valley.org
Eric Zuniga, San Bernardino District Engineer, SWRCB-DDW (via email)

File: 7A360101001, GT-WDR100031522, HDWD Wastewater Reclamation Plant, R7-
2015-0043